

Information Security and Acceptable Use Policy

Fictional policy document prepared for training and RAG testing

Policy ID	IT-POL-004
Version	1.5
Effective date	1 July 2026
Policy owner	Chief Information Security Officer
Applies to	Employees, contractors, interns and authorized third parties

Important: This is a fictional internal policy corpus. It is not legal advice and should not be adopted without review under applicable employment, tax, privacy, safety, and local labor laws.

1. Purpose

Oakline protects customer records, employee data, furniture designs, CAD files, supplier pricing, production schedules and business systems. This policy explains acceptable use of devices, email, internet, cloud services, passwords, removable media, generative AI and incident reporting.

2. Data classification

Class	Examples	Handling
Public	Published catalog, approved marketing material	May be shared externally after normal approval.
Internal	Policies, internal directories, routine process documents	Share only with authorized workforce members.
Confidential	Customer data, employee records, pricing, contracts, supplier terms	Need-to-know access; approved storage and transmission only.
Restricted	Credentials, payment data, unreleased designs, security logs, investigation records	Strongest controls; limited named access; external sharing requires formal approval.

3. Accounts, passwords and authentication

- Use a unique passphrase of at least 14 characters where supported. Do not reuse company passwords on personal services.
- Multi-factor authentication must be enabled for email, VPN, cloud administration and other designated systems.
- Never share a password, one-time code, authentication approval or access badge. IT will not ask for your password.
- Lock the screen when unattended and report suspected account compromise immediately.

- Access is granted according to role and removed or changed when responsibilities change or employment ends.

4. Device and software use

- Company devices are primarily for business use. Limited personal use is allowed if lawful, brief, secure and does not interfere with work.
- Only approved software, browser extensions, remote-access tools and cloud storage may be installed or used for company information.
- Do not disable antivirus, encryption, logging, mobile-device management, firewall or security updates.
- Lost, stolen or damaged devices must be reported to IT and the manager immediately, even when the device is believed to be powered off.
- USB storage is blocked by default. Approved encrypted media may be issued for a documented business need.

5. Email, messaging and phishing

Employees must verify unusual payment, bank-detail, credential, gift-card, payroll, customer-refund or urgent executive requests using a trusted second channel. Suspicious links, attachments, QR codes and login pages should be reported through the phishing-report function. Do not forward suspicious content to colleagues as a warning; use the reporting tool.

6. Generative AI and external online tools

Permitted	Prohibited without written approval
Drafting generic text, brainstorming, summarizing public material in an approved enterprise AI service.	Uploading customer data, employee data, contracts, source code, CAD drawings, unreleased designs, pricing, credentials or restricted information to public AI tools.
Using anonymized or synthetic examples for learning.	Using AI output as final legal, safety, engineering, financial or employment advice without qualified review.
Reviewing AI output for accuracy, bias, confidentiality and intellectual-property risk.	Connecting unapproved AI agents or plugins to company email, drives, databases or production systems.

7. Remote work and personal devices

- Use the company VPN where required and avoid public shared computers.
- Confidential conversations should not be audible to unauthorized persons. Screens must not be visible in public spaces.
- Personal devices may access company email only when enrolled in approved security controls. Local downloads may be restricted or remotely removed.
- Home routers should use supported encryption and a non-default administrator password.

8. Monitoring and privacy

To protect systems and comply with law, Oakline may log access, email metadata, internet destinations, file transfers, device health, authentication, security alerts and use of company systems. Monitoring will be proportionate, authorized and used for security, operations, investigations or legal obligations. Employees should not expect personal privacy when using company systems, while personal information will still be handled according to applicable privacy requirements.

9. Security incident reporting

Incident	Immediate action
Clicked suspicious link or entered password	Disconnect if instructed, call IT Security, change password through trusted portal, preserve evidence.
Sent data to wrong recipient	Contact IT Security immediately; do not rely only on recall/delete.
Lost device or access card	Report immediately to IT/Security and manager; provide last known location and time.
Malware, unusual pop-up, unexpected MFA prompt	Stop activity, do not approve prompts, contact IT Security.
Suspected insider misuse or data theft	Report confidentially to Security, Compliance or Ethics channel; do not confront or investigate personally.

Report immediately and no later than one hour after becoming aware of a suspected security incident. Good-faith prompt reporting is encouraged even when the employee caused the mistake.

10. Exit and role-change controls

Before separation or transfer, employees must return equipment, transfer business records, remove unauthorized local copies and stop using company access. Managers must request timely access changes. Confidentiality and intellectual-property obligations continue after employment.